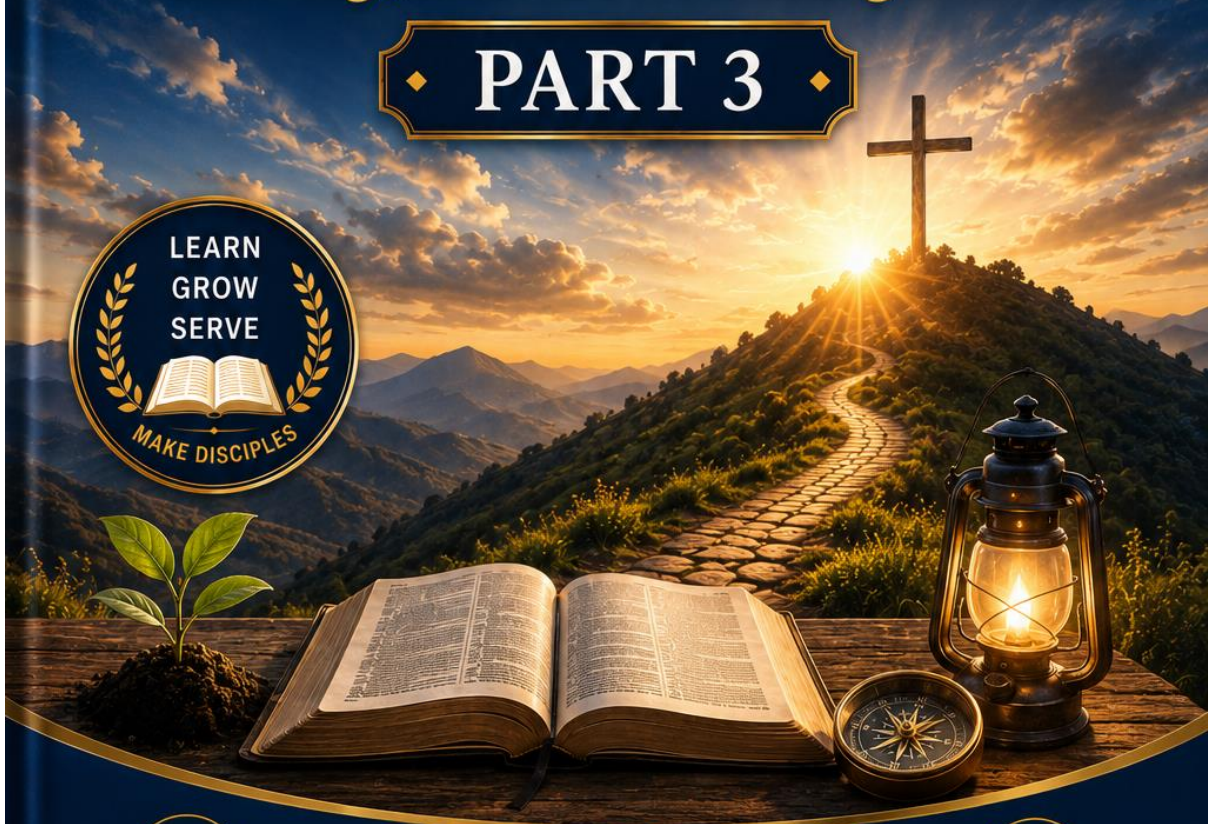


A BIBLICAL GUIDE TO GROWTH,
MATURITY, AND MAKING DISCIPLES

DISCIPLESHIP

Following Jesus and Becoming Like Him

♦ PART 3 ♦



FELLOWSHIP
& CHURCH LIFE



WORSHIP
IN SPIRIT & TRUTH



THE HOLY
SPIRIT



CHRISTIAN
CHARACTER



STEWARDSHIP
& SERVICE



GRACEPATH
NETWORK

GROWING IN CHRIST. WALKING IN GRACE. IMPACTING LIVES.

DISCIPLESHIP – PART 3

Introduction

Part One of this discipleship journey established the foundation of the Christian life by introducing the call to follow Jesus Christ, the cost of discipleship, and the assurance of salvation. Part Two focused on developing spiritual disciplines such as baptism, prayer, fellowship, worship, and life within the Church.

Part Three moves believers toward spiritual maturity, Spirit-filled living, and faithful service. God does not desire His children to remain spiritual infants. He calls every believer to grow in character, walk in the power of the Holy Spirit, develop godly relationships, and faithfully manage the resources He has entrusted to them.

In these lessons, we will explore subjects such as **Fellowship and the Life of the Church, Worship, The Holy Spirit, Christian Character and Spiritual Maturity, and Stewardship**. These teachings are designed to help believers become strong, fruitful, and effective disciples who influence others for Christ.

The Christian life is not merely about receiving blessings from God; it is about becoming more like Jesus Christ. As believers yield themselves to the Holy Spirit, practice biblical principles, and faithfully serve others, they grow in wisdom, humility, love, and spiritual effectiveness.

God has given every believer spiritual gifts, talents, opportunities, and resources to be used for His glory. He desires disciples who worship wholeheartedly, walk in obedience, display Christlike character, and serve faithfully in His Kingdom.

May Part Three inspire you to pursue spiritual maturity, rely upon the Holy Spirit daily, and embrace your calling as a steward of God's grace. As you continue this journey, may your life increasingly reflect the beauty, holiness, and compassion of Jesus Christ.

Theme Scripture

Ephesians 4:13–15 (NKJV)

"Till we all come to the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to a perfect man, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ; but, speaking the truth in love, may grow up in all things into Him who is the head—Christ."

Opening Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for saving me and calling me to grow into the likeness of Jesus Christ. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit and help me develop godly character, faithful stewardship, and a heart that delights in worship and service. Teach me to use my gifts for the benefit of others and for the advancement of Your Kingdom. May my life bring honour and glory to Your name.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

CHAPTER 1

Fellowship and the Life of the Church

Theme Scripture

Hebrews 10:24–25 (NKJV)

“And let us consider one another in order to stir up love and good works, not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as is the manner of some, but exhorting one another, and so much the more as you see the Day approaching.”

Key Verse

Acts 2:42 (NKJV)

“And they continued steadfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and in prayers.”

Introduction

Christianity was never intended to be lived in isolation. When a person receives Jesus Christ as Lord and Saviour, he or she becomes part of a spiritual family known as the Church. God designed believers to grow

together, worship together, serve together, and encourage one another in their journey of faith.

Many people today prefer an independent Christian life, believing they can grow spiritually without meaningful relationships with other believers. While personal prayer and Bible study are essential, God has provided the fellowship of the Church as a vital means for spiritual growth and maturity.

Healthy fellowship strengthens believers, provides accountability, develops spiritual gifts, and demonstrates God's love to the world.

1. What Is Fellowship?

The New Testament word for fellowship is **koinonia**, which means sharing, partnership, participation, and communion.

Christian fellowship is more than casual friendship or social gatherings.

It involves believers sharing life together in Christ.

Biblical fellowship includes:

- Worshiping together
- Studying God's Word together
- Praying together
- Serving one another

- Encouraging one another
 - Supporting one another during difficult times
-

2. The Church: God's Family

Ephesians 2:19 (NKJV)

“Now, therefore, you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of God.”

The Church is not merely a building.

The Church is the people of God.

The Bible describes the Church in several ways:

The Body of Christ

1 Corinthians 12:27

Believers function together as different parts of one body.

Each member has a unique purpose.

The Bride of Christ

Ephesians 5:25–27

Jesus loves the Church and cares for her.

The Household of God

1 Timothy 3:15

Believers belong to one spiritual family.

3. Why Fellowship Is Important

Encouragement

Hebrews 3:13 (NKJV)

“But exhort one another daily...”

Believers need encouragement to remain faithful.

Difficult seasons become easier when Christians support one another.

Accountability

Trusted believers help us remain faithful to God's standards.

They lovingly correct us when we drift from God's path.

Proverbs 27:17 (NKJV)

“As iron sharpens iron, so a man sharpens the countenance of his friend.”

Spiritual Growth

Listening to biblical teaching and participating in discussions strengthens understanding.

Observing mature believers also provides practical examples of Christian living.

Unity

Christian fellowship demonstrates the unity that Christ desires among His followers.

John 17:21 (NKJV)

“That they all may be one...”

4. The Early Church as a Model

The first believers devoted themselves to four important practices.

Acts 2:42

- Apostles' teaching
- Fellowship
- Breaking of bread
- Prayer

As a result:

People experienced joy.

Needs were met.

New believers were added.

The Church continued growing.

5. Using Spiritual Gifts

God gives spiritual gifts to believers for the benefit of the Church.

Examples include:

Teaching

Encouragement

Giving

Leadership

Serving

Mercy

Hospitality

1 Peter 4:10 (NKJV)

“As each one has received a gift, minister it to one another, as good stewards of the manifold grace of God.”

Every believer has something valuable to contribute.

6. Maintaining Healthy Fellowship

Healthy relationships require effort.

Believers should:

Speak truth in love.

Forgive one another.

Avoid gossip.

Practice humility.

Serve willingly.

Pray for one another.

Bear one another's burdens.

Galatians 6:2 (NKJV)

“Bear one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.”

7. Obstacles to Fellowship

Several attitudes can damage fellowship.

Pride

Pride prevents believers from admitting mistakes and receiving correction.

Unforgiveness

Bitterness destroys relationships.

Selfishness

Focusing only on personal needs weakens unity.

Neglect

Failing to participate in church activities limits opportunities for growth.

Illustration

A single piece of charcoal removed from a fire gradually loses its heat.

However, when returned to the burning coals, it quickly becomes hot again.

Likewise, believers who isolate themselves often become spiritually weak, while those who remain connected to the body of Christ are strengthened and encouraged.

Reflection Questions

1. Why is fellowship essential for spiritual growth?
2. How can you contribute positively to your church family?
3. What spiritual gifts do you believe God has given you?
4. Are there relationships that need forgiveness or restoration?
5. How can you encourage another believer this week?

Memory Verse

Hebrews 10:25 (NKJV)

“Not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together... but exhorting one another.”

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for placing me in the family of believers. Help me to value fellowship, serve others faithfully, and maintain unity within the Church. Teach me to encourage others, forgive freely, and use my gifts for

Your glory. May my relationships reflect the love of Jesus Christ.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

Points to Remember

- Fellowship is a vital part of Christian discipleship.
- The Church is the Body of Christ and the family of God.
- Believers grow stronger through encouragement and accountability.
- Every Christian has spiritual gifts to serve others.
- Unity, humility, and forgiveness strengthen fellowship.

CHAPTER 2

Worship: Living a Life That Honours God

Theme Scripture

John 4:23–24 (NKJV)

“But the hour is coming, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth; for the Father is seeking such to worship Him. God is Spirit, and those who worship Him must worship in spirit and truth.”

Key Verse

Romans 12:1 (NKJV)

“I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your reasonable service.”

Introduction

Worship is one of the highest privileges and greatest responsibilities of every believer. God created humanity for fellowship with Himself and for His glory.

Throughout Scripture, we see men and women responding to God's greatness with praise, thanksgiving, obedience, and devotion.

Many people think worship is limited to singing songs during a church service. While singing is an important expression of worship, biblical worship is much broader. Worship involves every aspect of our lives. It is a response of love, reverence, and surrender to God for who He is and for what He has done.

True worship changes our hearts, strengthens our faith, and deepens our relationship with God. A disciple of Jesus learns to worship not only in church gatherings but also in daily life.

1. What Is Worship?

Worship is giving God the honour, reverence, and devotion that belong to Him alone.

Worship recognizes:

- God's holiness
- God's power
- God's love
- God's wisdom
- God's faithfulness

Worship is our response to God's character and His works.

Psalm 95:6 (NKJV)

“Oh come, let us worship and bow down; let us kneel before the LORD our Maker.”

2. Worshiping in Spirit and Truth

John 4:23–24 (NKJV)

Jesus taught that true worshipers worship in spirit and truth.

Worship in Spirit

Worship should come from a sincere heart.

It should not merely be an outward performance.

True worship involves:

Love

Faith

Humility

Gratitude

Dependence upon God

Worship in Truth

Worship must be based upon God's revealed truth.

Believers worship according to what Scripture teaches about God.

True worship is not guided by emotions alone.

It is grounded in biblical understanding.

3. Worship Through Praise

Praise is expressing admiration and gratitude to God.

Psalm 150:6 (NKJV)

“Let everything that has breath praise the LORD.”

Praise may include:

Singing

Clapping hands

Lifting hands

Playing instruments

Speaking words of thanksgiving

Celebrating God's goodness

Praise shifts our focus from problems to God's greatness.

4. Worship Through Obedience

God desires obedience more than religious rituals.

1 Samuel 15:22 (NKJV)

“To obey is better than sacrifice.”

A believer worships God by:

Forgiving others

Speaking truth

Serving faithfully

Living morally pure lives

Keeping God's commandments

Daily obedience honours God.

5. Worship Through Giving

Giving is an act of worship.

Believers acknowledge that everything belongs to God.

2 Corinthians 9:7 (NKJV)

“So let each one give as he purposes in his heart, not grudgingly or of necessity; for God loves a cheerful giver.”

Giving may include:

Money

Time

Talents

Hospitality

Acts of kindness

Helping those in need

6. Worship Through Service

Jesus demonstrated servant-hearted worship.

Mark 10:45 (NKJV)

“For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve.”

Serving others reflects Christ's love.

Examples include:

Teaching children

Cleaning the church

Visiting the sick

Encouraging the discouraged

Helping the elderly

Supporting missions

7. Worship During Difficult Times

Worship is not limited to seasons of blessing.

Believers can worship God even during suffering.

Job 1:21 (NKJV)

“The LORD gave, and the LORD has taken away; blessed be the name of the LORD.”

Acts 16:25 (NKJV)

Paul and Silas prayed and sang hymns while imprisoned.

Worship during hardship demonstrates trust in God's sovereignty.

8. Hindrances to Worship

Several attitudes can hinder true worship.

Sin

Unconfessed sin damages fellowship with God.

Pride

Pride focuses attention on ourselves rather than God.

Distractions

Worldly concerns may prevent wholehearted devotion.

Hypocrisy

Outward expressions without inward sincerity do not please God.

Matthew 15:8 (NKJV)

“These people draw near to Me with their mouth, and honour Me with their lips, but their heart is far from Me.”

Illustration

A musician carefully tunes an instrument before playing it.

An untuned instrument produces unpleasant sounds.

Likewise, believers should allow God to tune their hearts through repentance, prayer, and obedience so that their worship becomes pleasing to Him.

Reflection Questions

1. How would you define worship?
 2. In what ways can worship extend beyond singing?
 3. What distractions hinder your worship?
 4. How can obedience become an act of worship?
 5. How do you respond to God during difficult seasons?
-

Memory Verse

Romans 12:1 (NKJV)

“Present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your reasonable service.”

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

You alone are worthy of all honour, praise, and worship. Teach me to worship You with sincerity, obedience, and gratitude. Help me to glorify You not only with my words but also through my thoughts, actions, and daily choices. May my entire life become an offering that brings pleasure to You.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

Points to Remember

- Worship is a response to who God is and what He has done.
- True worship is offered in spirit and truth.
- Worship involves praise, obedience, giving, and service.
- Believers can worship God even in difficult circumstances.
- A lifestyle of worship honours God and draws believers closer to Him.

CHAPTER 3

The Holy Spirit: The Believer's Helper and Guide

Theme Scripture

John 14:16–17 (NKJV)

“And I will pray the Father, and He will give you another Helper, that He may abide with you forever—the Spirit of truth...”

Key Verse

Acts 1:8 (NKJV)

“But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me...”

Introduction

One of God's greatest gifts to believers is the Holy Spirit. Jesus promised that after His departure, He would send the Holy Spirit to dwell within His followers, guide them into truth, empower them for service, and help them live victorious Christian lives.

Many believers understand God the Father and Jesus Christ the Son, but they often have questions about the Holy Spirit. Who is He? What does He do? How does He work in the life of a believer?

The Holy Spirit is not merely a force, influence, or feeling. He is the third Person of the Trinity—fully God, eternal, holy, and active in the lives of God's people.

A disciple who learns to walk with the Holy Spirit experiences greater spiritual growth, wisdom, strength, and effectiveness in ministry.

1. Who Is the Holy Spirit?

The Holy Spirit is God.

The Bible teaches that God exists eternally as:

- God the Father
- God the Son
- God the Holy Spirit

These three Persons are one God.

Matthew 28:19 (NKJV)

“Baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.”

The Holy Spirit possesses divine attributes.

He is:

- Eternal
 - Holy
 - All-knowing
 - All-powerful
 - Present everywhere
-

2. The Holy Spirit in the Life of a Believer

When a person receives Jesus Christ as Saviour, the Holy Spirit comes to live within them.

Romans 8:9 (NKJV)

“Now if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he is not His.”

The Holy Spirit establishes God's presence in the believer's life.

He continually works to transform us into the likeness of Christ.

3. The Holy Spirit Convicts of Sin

John 16:8 (NKJV)

“And when He has come, He will convict the world of sin, and of righteousness, and of judgment.”

Before salvation, the Holy Spirit reveals our need for Christ.

After salvation, He continues to convict believers when they sin.

Conviction is not condemnation.

Conviction leads us toward repentance and restoration.

4. The Holy Spirit Teaches and Guides

John 14:26 (NKJV)

“But the Helper, the Holy Spirit... He will teach you all things.”

The Holy Spirit helps believers understand Scripture.

He provides wisdom and direction.

He reminds believers of God's truth when they need it most.

Practical Ways He Guides

- Through Scripture
- Through prayer
- Through godly counsel
- Through inner conviction
- Through circumstances that align with God's will

The Holy Spirit never leads contrary to God's Word.

5. The Holy Spirit Gives Power for Christian Living

The Christian life cannot be lived successfully through human effort alone.

Believers need divine strength.

Acts 1:8 (NKJV)

“You shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you.”

The Holy Spirit empowers believers to:

- Overcome temptation
 - Serve faithfully
 - Share the Gospel boldly
 - Endure hardship
 - Grow spiritually
-

6. The Fruit of the Spirit

The Holy Spirit produces Christlike character in believers.

Galatians 5:22–23 (NKJV)

“But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control.”

These qualities are evidence of spiritual maturity.

The Fruit of the Spirit

Love – Caring for God and others.

Joy – Deep happiness rooted in God.

Peace – Confidence and rest in God's care.

Patience – Enduring difficulties without complaining.

Kindness – Showing compassion and generosity.

Goodness – Living uprightly.

Faithfulness – Remaining dependable and loyal.

Gentleness – Treating others with humility.

Self-Control – Governing desires and actions.

7. Spiritual Gifts

The Holy Spirit gives spiritual gifts to believers for ministry.

1 Corinthians 12:7 (NKJV)

“But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to each one for the profit of all.”

Examples include:

- Teaching
- Leadership
- Encouragement
- Giving
- Mercy
- Service
- Evangelism

These gifts are given to build up the Church and glorify God.

8. Grieving the Holy Spirit

Believers are instructed not to grieve the Holy Spirit.

Ephesians 4:30 (NKJV)

“And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God.”

We grieve Him when we:

- Harbour bitterness
- Practice dishonesty
- Live in disobedience
- Refuse to forgive
- Ignore God's leading

A sensitive heart quickly responds to His correction.

9. Walking in the Spirit

Galatians 5:16 (NKJV)

“Walk in the Spirit, and you shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.”

Walking in the Spirit means living daily under His guidance and control.

Practical Steps

- Spend time in prayer.
 - Study God's Word regularly.
 - Obey God's commands.
 - Listen to the Spirit's conviction.
 - Stay connected to Christian fellowship.
 - Depend on God's strength rather than your own.
-

Illustration

A sailing boat cannot move effectively without wind filling its sails.

Likewise, believers cannot live effectively for Christ without the empowering work of the Holy Spirit.

The more we yield ourselves to Him, the more effectively He directs our lives.

Reflection Questions

1. Who is the Holy Spirit?
2. What role does the Holy Spirit play in your daily life?
3. Which fruit of the Spirit needs greater development in your life?
4. How can you become more sensitive to His guidance?

5. What spiritual gifts do you believe God has given you?

Memory Verse

Acts 1:8 (NKJV)

“But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me.”

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for giving the Holy Spirit to guide, strengthen, and transform me. Help me to walk in obedience, listen to His voice, and rely upon His power each day. Produce the fruit of the Spirit in my life and use me to serve others for Your glory.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

Points to Remember

- The Holy Spirit is the third Person of the Trinity.
- He lives within every believer.
- He convicts, teaches, guides, and empowers.
- He produces spiritual fruit in the lives of believers.
- He equips believers with spiritual gifts for ministry.

- Walking in the Spirit leads to spiritual growth and victory.

CHAPTER 4

Developing Christian Character and Spiritual Maturity

Theme Scripture

Romans 8:29 (NKJV)

“For whom He foreknew, He also predestined to be conformed to the image of His Son.”

Key Verse

2 Peter 3:18 (NKJV)

“But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. To Him be the glory both now and forever. Amen.”

Introduction

God's desire for every believer is not merely salvation, but transformation. He wants His children to become increasingly like Jesus Christ in their attitudes, thoughts, words, and actions. This process is called **spiritual growth** or **spiritual maturity**.

When a person first receives Christ, he or she begins a new life as a spiritual infant. Just as a child must grow

physically, believers must also grow spiritually. Spiritual maturity does not happen automatically. It requires intentional effort, obedience to God's Word, dependence upon the Holy Spirit, and perseverance through life's experiences.

A mature Christian reflects the character of Christ, remains faithful during difficulties, serves others humbly, and demonstrates wisdom in everyday living.

1. What Is Christian Character?

Christian character refers to the qualities and attitudes that reflect the nature of Jesus Christ.

Character is revealed by how we think, speak, and behave when no one is watching.

God is more interested in who we are becoming than merely what we accomplish.

Proverbs 22:1 (NKJV)

“A good name is to be chosen rather than great riches.”

Christian character influences:

- Family relationships
- Friendships
- Ministry effectiveness
- Workplace conduct

- Personal testimony

2. God's Goal for Every Believer

Romans 8:29 (NKJV)

“To be conformed to the image of His Son.”

God's ultimate purpose is to make believers resemble Jesus.

Jesus demonstrated:

Love

Compassion

Humility

Patience

Holiness

Obedience

Faithfulness

Forgiveness

Believers are called to follow His example.

1 Peter 2:21 (NKJV)

“Christ also suffered for us, leaving us an example, that you should follow His steps.”

3. Marks of Spiritual Maturity

Love

John 13:35 (NKJV)

“By this all will know that you are My disciples, if you have love for one another.”

Love is the greatest evidence of spiritual maturity.

Mature believers care for others, forgive freely, and seek unity.

Humility

Philippians 2:3 (NKJV)

“In lowliness of mind let each esteem others better than himself.”

Humility acknowledges dependence upon God.

Humble believers welcome correction and serve willingly.

Patience

Patience enables believers to endure challenges without becoming discouraged.

James 1:4 (NKJV)

“But let patience have its perfect work, that you may be perfect and complete, lacking nothing.”

Integrity

Integrity means living consistently according to biblical values.

A mature believer behaves honestly in both public and private settings.

Proverbs 10:9 (NKJV)

“He who walks with integrity walks securely.”

Self-Control

Self-control allows believers to manage emotions, desires, and speech.

Proverbs 25:28 (NKJV)

“Whoever has no rule over his own spirit is like a city broken down, without walls.”

4. How Spiritual Growth Takes Place Through God's Word

The Bible nourishes spiritual life.

1 Peter 2:2 (NKJV)

“As new-born babes, desire the pure milk of the word, that you may grow thereby.”

Through Prayer

Prayer strengthens fellowship with God and deepens faith.

Through Fellowship

Relationships with other believers provide encouragement and accountability.

Through Trials

God uses difficulties to develop perseverance and maturity.

James 1:2–4 (NKJV)

“Count it all joy when you fall into various trials.”

Trials teach believers to trust God more deeply.

5. Hindrances to Spiritual Growth

Several factors may slow spiritual development.

Neglecting God's Word

Spiritual malnutrition occurs when believers ignore Scripture.

Unconfessed Sin

Sin weakens fellowship with God.

Pride

Pride resists correction and instruction.

Worldliness

Allowing worldly values to shape priorities hinders maturity.

Romans 12:2 (NKJV)

“Do not be conformed to this world.”

6. Pressing Toward Maturity

Philippians 3:13–14 (NKJV)

“Forgetting those things which are behind and reaching forward to those things which are ahead.”

Believers should continually pursue growth.

Spiritual maturity is not perfection.

It is a lifelong process of becoming more like Christ.

Practical Steps

Read the Bible daily.

Pray consistently.

Attend church faithfully.

Serve others.

Share your faith.

Seek godly mentors.

Remain teachable.

Biblical Examples of Maturity

Joseph

Joseph remained faithful despite betrayal and suffering.

Daniel

Daniel maintained his devotion to God in a pagan culture.

Timothy

Timothy grew under Paul's mentorship and became a faithful leader.

Jesus

Jesus perfectly demonstrated spiritual maturity.

Luke 2:52 (NKJV)

“And Jesus increased in wisdom and stature, and in favour with God and men.”

Illustration

A fruit tree does not produce fruit immediately after planting.

It requires time, nourishment, pruning, and proper care.

Eventually, it produces healthy fruit.

Likewise, believers grow spiritually through consistent obedience, learning, and dependence upon God.

Reflection Questions

1. Which character qualities do you most admire in Jesus?
 2. What areas of your character need further growth?
 3. How have trials strengthened your faith?
 4. What habits help you mature spiritually?
 5. Who has influenced your spiritual growth?
-

Memory Verse

2 Peter 3:18 (NKJV)

“But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.”

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for calling me to become more like Jesus Christ. Shape my character, strengthen my faith, and help me remain teachable. Produce humility, love, patience, and integrity in my life. May others see Christ

reflected in me as I continue to grow in spiritual maturity.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

Points to Remember

- God's goal is to conform believers to the image of Christ.
- Spiritual maturity develops through prayer, Scripture, fellowship, and trials.
- Christian character reflects the nature of Jesus.
- Spiritual growth is a lifelong journey.
- Mature believers influence others through godly living.

CHAPTER 5

Stewardship: Managing God's Resources Faithfully

Theme Scripture

1 Corinthians 4:2 (NKJV)

“Moreover it is required in stewards that one be found faithful.”

Key Verse

Matthew 25:21 (NKJV)

“Well done, good and faithful servant; you were faithful over a few things, I will make you ruler over many things. Enter into the joy of your lord.”

Introduction

Everything we possess ultimately belongs to God. Our lives, abilities, opportunities, possessions, relationships, and finances are gifts entrusted to us by our Heavenly Father. God has appointed believers as stewards, responsible for managing His resources wisely and faithfully.

Stewardship is much more than giving money to the church. It encompasses every aspect of life. Faithful stewards recognize that they are managers rather than owners. They seek to honour God through responsible decisions, generous giving, diligent service, and careful use of time and talents.

A disciple of Jesus understands that stewardship is an expression of worship and gratitude toward God.

1. Understanding Stewardship

A steward is someone entrusted with the responsibility of managing another person's property or affairs.

The Bible teaches that believers are stewards of God's blessings.

Psalms 24:1 (NKJV)

“The earth is the LORD'S, and all its fullness, the world and those who dwell therein.”

God owns everything.

Believers are called to manage His resources according to His purposes.

Stewardship involves:

- Time
- Talents
- Finances
- Possessions
- Spiritual gifts
- Relationships
- Opportunities

2. Stewardship of Time

Time is one of God's most valuable gifts.

Every person receives twenty-four hours each day.

How we spend our time reveals our priorities.

Ephesians 5:15–16 (NKJV)

“See then that you walk circumspectly, not as fools but as wise, redeeming the time, because the days are evil.”

Wise stewards:

Set godly priorities.

Avoid unnecessary distractions.

Maintain balance between work, family, ministry, and rest.

Spend time in prayer and Bible study.

Practical Suggestions

Establish a daily devotional time.

Plan important activities.

Limit time-wasting habits.

Use opportunities to serve others.

3. Stewardship of Talents and Abilities

God gives every believer unique abilities.

These talents should be used to glorify Him.

1 Peter 4:10 (NKJV)

“As each one has received a gift, minister it to one another.”

Examples of talents include:

Teaching

Music

Leadership

Writing

Administration

Craftsmanship

Counselling

Hospitality

Encouragement

Believers should not compare themselves with others.

Instead, they should faithfully develop and use the gifts God has provided.

4. Stewardship of Finances

Money is a tool entrusted by God.

The Bible does not condemn wealth itself, but it warns against loving money.

1 Timothy 6:10 (NKJV)

“For the love of money is a root of all kinds of evil.”

Believers should manage finances with wisdom.

Principles of Financial Stewardship

Earn honestly.

Spend responsibly.

Save wisely.

Avoid unnecessary debt.

Give generously.

Trust God for provision.

Giving as Worship

Giving reflects gratitude and dependence upon God.

2 Corinthians 9:7 (NKJV)

“So let each one give as he purposes in his heart, not grudgingly or of necessity; for God loves a cheerful giver.”

Giving should be:

Willing

Joyful

Regular

Sacrificial

Faith-filled

5. Stewardship of Spiritual Gifts

The Holy Spirit equips believers with gifts for ministry.

These gifts are intended to strengthen the Church.

Romans 12:6–8 (NKJV)

Examples include:

Prophecy

Teaching

Serving

Encouragement

Giving

Leadership

Mercy

Faithful stewards use their gifts humbly and diligently.

6. Stewardship of Relationships

God entrusts people to our care.

Believers should nurture healthy relationships.

Colossians 3:13 (NKJV)

“Bearing with one another, and forgiving one another.”

Stewardship in relationships includes:

Showing kindness.

Practicing forgiveness.

Encouraging family members.

Supporting fellow believers.

Sharing the Gospel with unbelievers.

7. The Parable of the Talents

Matthew 25:14–30

Jesus told a story about a master who entrusted resources to his servants.

Two servants used their resources wisely and received praise.

One servant hid his talent and was rebuked.

Lessons from the Parable

God entrusts resources according to ability.

God expects faithfulness.

God rewards diligent service.

Neglecting opportunities displeases God.

8. Rewards for Faithful Stewardship

Faithful stewardship brings blessings.

These may include:

Spiritual growth.

Greater opportunities for service.

Influence for God's Kingdom.

Joy in serving Christ.

Eternal rewards.

Matthew 25:21 (NKJV)

“Well done, good and faithful servant.”

Illustration

A gardener receives seeds and carefully plants, waters, and protects them.

Over time, the seeds produce fruit.

If the gardener neglects them, little or nothing grows.

Likewise, God has entrusted each believer with resources that should be cultivated and used for His glory.

Reflection Questions

1. What resources has God entrusted to you?
2. How do you currently manage your time?
3. Which talents can you use more effectively for God's Kingdom?
4. Are there areas where your financial habits need improvement?
5. What changes can help you become a more faithful steward?

Memory Verse

1 Corinthians 4:2 (NKJV)

“Moreover it is required in stewards that one be found faithful.”

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for entrusting me with time, abilities, possessions, and opportunities. Help me to manage these gifts wisely and faithfully. Teach me to be generous, diligent, and responsible in every area of life. May all that I have and all that I do bring honour and glory to Your name.

In Jesus' name, Amen.

Points to Remember

- God owns everything.
- Believers are stewards, not owners.
- Stewardship includes time, talents, finances, relationships, and spiritual gifts.
- Faithfulness matters more than the amount entrusted.
- God rewards those who manage His resources wisely.
- **Conclusion – Discipleship Part 3**
- As we conclude **Part Three** of this discipleship journey, we are reminded that God's desire for every believer is continual growth into the likeness of Jesus Christ. Salvation marks the beginning of our relationship with God, but spiritual maturity is

the ongoing process of allowing the Holy Spirit to transform our hearts, minds, and actions.

- In these lessons, we have learned the importance of fellowship within the body of Christ, the privilege and responsibility of worship, the ministry and power of the Holy Spirit, the development of Christian character, and the faithful stewardship of God's resources. These truths equip believers to live fruitful, balanced, and Spirit-filled lives.
- We discovered that spiritual maturity is not measured by how long a person has been a Christian, but by how closely that person's life reflects the character of Jesus Christ. Mature disciples demonstrate love, humility, integrity, patience, faithfulness, and a willingness to serve others. They rely upon the Holy Spirit for guidance, use their spiritual gifts faithfully, and seek opportunities to glorify God in every area of life.
- Stewardship reminds us that everything we possess belongs to God. Our time, abilities, finances, relationships, and opportunities are gifts entrusted to us for His purposes. Faithful disciples recognize that they are managers rather than owners and seek to hear the Master's commendation, "**Well done, good and faithful servant.**"
- As you continue your discipleship journey, pursue spiritual growth with determination and joy. Remain teachable, stay connected to other believers, walk in the Spirit, and faithfully serve

wherever God places you. May your life become a testimony of God's grace and a blessing to those around you.

- **Closing Scripture**
- **Philippians 1:6 (NKJV)**
- *"Being confident of this very thing, that He who has begun a good work in you will complete it until the day of Jesus Christ."*
- **Closing Prayer**
- **Heavenly Father,**
- Thank You for teaching me through these lessons and helping me grow in faith and maturity.
Continue shaping my character to reflect Jesus Christ. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit, help me to worship sincerely, serve faithfully, and manage Your blessings wisely. May my life honour You and encourage others to follow Christ wholeheartedly.
- **In Jesus' name, Amen.**

DISCIPLESHIP – PART 3

Final Examination

SECTION A – MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

Choose the correct answer. (2 Marks each)

1. The New Testament word for fellowship is:

- A. Agape
- B. Koinonia
- C. Logos
- D. Charis

2. The Church is primarily:

- A. A building
- B. A denomination
- C. The people of God
- D. A social organization

3. True worshipers worship God:

- A. In emotion only
- B. In spirit and truth
- C. In silence only
- D. Through music only

4. The Holy Spirit is:

- A. An angel
- B. A force
- C. The third Person of the Trinity
- D. A prophet

5. The fruit of the Spirit is found in:

- A. Romans 8
- B. Galatians 5
- C. Acts 2
- D. Hebrews 11

6. Spiritual maturity means:

- A. Knowing many Bible verses
- B. Becoming like Christ
- C. Holding church positions
- D. Being older in age

7. Stewardship teaches that:

- A. Believers own everything
- B. God owns everything
- C. Churches own everything
- D. Pastors own everything

8. Which of the following is NOT a spiritual gift?

- A. Encouragement
- B. Leadership
- C. Mercy
- D. Greed

9. The memory verse for Stewardship is:

- A. Matthew 28:19
- B. Romans 12:1
- C. 1 Corinthians 4:2
- D. John 14:6

10. According to Romans 8:29, believers are to be conformed to:

- A. Church traditions
- B. Society

- C. The image of Christ
 - D. Religious leaders
-

SECTION B – TRUE OR FALSE

Write TRUE or FALSE. (2 Marks each)

11. Fellowship is optional for Christian growth.

 12. Worship includes obedience and service.

 13. The Holy Spirit convicts believers of sin.

 14. Pride promotes spiritual maturity. _____
 15. Christian character reflects the nature of Jesus Christ. _____
 16. Stewardship only involves money.

 17. Every believer has spiritual gifts. _____
 18. Trials can strengthen spiritual maturity.

 19. God rewards faithful stewardship. _____
 20. Walking in the Spirit helps believers overcome temptation. _____
-

SECTION C – SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

Answer briefly. (5 Marks each)

21. Mention four benefits of Christian fellowship.

a) _____

b) _____

c) _____

d) _____

22. Name four ways believers can worship God.

a) _____

b) _____

c) _____

d) _____

23. List five qualities of the Fruit of the Spirit.

a) _____

b) _____

c) _____

d) _____

e) _____

24. Mention four marks of spiritual maturity.

a) _____

b) _____

c) _____

d) _____

25. What areas of life are included in stewardship?

a) _____

b) _____

c) _____

d) _____

e) _____

26. How can believers walk in the Spirit?

SECTION D – ESSAY QUESTIONS

Answer ANY TWO questions. (15 Marks each)

27. Explain the ministry of the Holy Spirit in the life of a believer.

28. Discuss the characteristics of a spiritually mature Christian.

29. Explain biblical stewardship and describe how believers can faithfully manage God's resources.

MEMORY VERSES

- **Hebrews 10:25**
- **Romans 12:1**
- **Acts 1:8**
- **2 Peter 3:18**
- **1 Corinthians 4:2**

A BIBLICAL GUIDE TO GROWTH,
MATURITY, AND MAKING DISCIPLES

DISCIPLESHIP

♦ PART 3 ♦

Following Jesus and Becoming Like Him

Part Three focuses on spiritual maturity, Spirit-filled living, and faithful service. These lessons equip believers to grow in character, walk in the power of the Holy Spirit, develop godly relationships, and steward God's resources for the advancement of His Kingdom.

As you continue this journey, may you be empowered to live a life that reflects Jesus Christ and brings glory to God in every area.

IN THIS PART, YOU WILL DISCOVER:



FELLOWSHIP & CHURCH LIFE

Understand the importance of unity, encouragement, and using spiritual gifts.



WORSHIP

Learn to worship God in spirit and truth with a thankful heart.



THE HOLY SPIRIT

Experience the presence, power, and guidance of the Holy Spirit daily.



CHRISTIAN CHARACTER

Develop Christlike character and grow into spiritual maturity.



STEWARDSHIP

Faithfully manage God's blessings and resources.



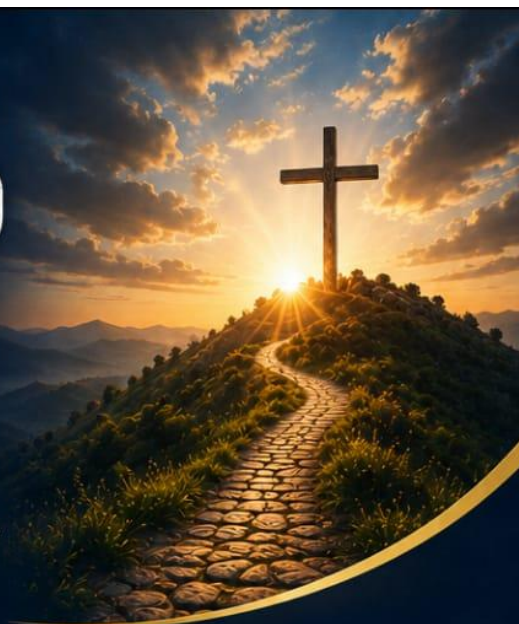
SERVICE

Discover the joy of serving others and making an eternal impact.



"Till we all come to the unity of the faith and of the knowledge of the Son of God, to a perfect man, to the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ."

EPHESIANS 4:13 (NKJV)



“And let us consider one another in order to stir up love and good works, not forsaking the assembling of ourselves together, as is the manner of some, but exhorting one another, and so much the more as you see the Day approaching.”

— Hebrews 10:24–25 (NKJV)

SCAN TO DISCOVER MORE

Free resources, discipleship tools, and encouragement for your journey.



GRACEPATH
NETWORK

GROWING IN CHRIST. WALKING IN GRACE. IMPACTING LIVES.



Email: gracepathnetwork@gmail.com



www.gracepathnetwork.com



GracePath Network